

rDataSet

The goal of rDataSet is to treat data frames as mathematical sets. It provides set-theoretic operations (union, intersection, difference, equality) for data frames where values are identified by row IDs and column names, and presence/absence is determined by NA values.

On top of Operations, Datasets support writing and reading to json, toml files. With the goal of having human readable Data representations which don't rely on table representations. (as there is a lack of decent diffing and viewing for such data, at least that's how I perceive it)

Installation

You can install the development version of rDataSet from local source like so:

```
devtools::install("/path/to/rDataSet")
# or with
install.packages("/path/to/rDataSet", repo = NULL, type = "source")
```

Overview

rDataSet introduces a **dataset** S3 class that extends data frames with designated ID columns. Set operations work on a cell-by-cell basis:

- **ID columns** uniquely identify each row (one-to-one relation)
- **Value presence** is determined by `is.na()` - a value is present if not NA
- **Set operations** compare cells at the same (row_id, col_id) position
- **Empty rows are dropped** - rows containing only NA values in all value columns are considered non-existent and are automatically removed during dataset construction

Set Operations

Each set operation works in two stages:

1. **Row/Column Alignment:** Determines which rows and columns appear in the result
2. **Value Operation:** Decides which values to keep for each cell

Operation	Rows in Result	Columns in Result
Difference (A - B)	All rows from A	All value columns from A
Intersection (A > B)	Only rows present in both A and B (inner join on IDs)	Only common value columns
Union (A + B)	All rows from both A and B (full join on IDs)	All value columns from both
Equality (A == B)	Must match exactly (same rows)	Must match exactly (same c

Note: ID columns must match between datasets for all operations. Value columns that exist in only one dataset are handled according to the join type (dropped, kept, or error).

Example

```
library(rDataSet)
library(tibble)
library(dplyr)

#>
#> Attaching package: 'dplyr'
#> The following objects are masked from 'package:stats':
#>
#> filter, lag
#> The following objects are masked from 'package:base':
#>
#> intersect, setdiff, setequal, union

# Create datasets with 'i' as the ID column
# Note: Rows with all-NA values in value columns are automatically dropped
A <- dataset_build(
  tibble(i = 1:10, b = if_else(1:10 %% 2 == 0, NA, 1:10), c = 1:10),
  ids = "i"
)

B <- dataset_build(
  tibble(i = 1:10, b = na_if(1:10, 3), c = 11:20),
  ids = "i"
)

# Dataset C has fewer rows (1:5) and an extra column 'd'
C <- dataset_build(
  tibble(i = 1:5, b = 10:6, d = 2),
  ids = "i"
)

# View the datasets
A
#> # A tibble: 10 × 3
#>       i     b     c
#>   <int> <int> <int>
#> 1     1     1     1
#> 2     2    NA     2
#> 3     3     3     3
#> 4     4    NA     4
#> 5     5     5     5
```

```
#> 6      6    NA     6
#> 7      7      7     7
#> 8      8    NA     8
#> 9      9      9     9
#> 10    10    NA    10
```

B

```
#> # A tibble: 10 × 3
#>       i         b         c
#>   <int> <int> <int>
#> 1     1     1     11
#> 2     2     2     12
#> 3     3     3    NA
#> 4     4     4     14
#> 5     5     5     15
#> 6     6     6     16
#> 7     7     7     17
#> 8     8     8     18
#> 9     9     9     19
#> 10    10    10    20
```

C

```
#> # A tibble: 5 × 3
#>       i         b         d
#>   <int> <int> <dbl>
#> 1     1     10     2
#> 2     2      9     2
#> 3     3      8     2
#> 4     4      7     2
#> 5     5      6     2
```

Set Difference

Keep values from A where B has NA (uses left join, so all rows from A):

A - B

```
#> # A tibble: 1 × 2
#>       i         b
#>   <int> <int>
#> 1     3     3
```

Difference with C shows how non-common columns are dropped:

A - C *# Only column 'b' remains (common), row ids 1:5 from A*

```
#> # A tibble: 10 × 3
#>       i         b         c
#>   <int> <int> <int>
#> 1     1     NA     1
#> 2     2     NA     2
```

```
#> 3      3    NA     3
#> 4      4    NA     4
#> 5      5    NA     5
#> 6      6    NA     6
#> 7      7     7     7
#> 8      8    NA     8
#> 9      9     9     9
#> 10     10   NA    10
```

Set Intersection

Keep values from A where B has non-NA values (inner join on rows, common columns only):

```
A > B
#> # A tibble: 10 × 3
#>       i     b     c
#>   <int> <int> <int>
#> 1     1     1     1
#> 2     2     2    NA
#> 3     3     3    NA
#> 4     4     4    NA
#> 5     5     5     5
#> 6     6     6    NA
#> 7     7     7     7
#> 8     8     8    NA
#> 9     9     9     9
#> 10    10    10   NA
```

Intersection with C - note only rows 1:5 and column 'b' are kept:

```
A > C
#> # A tibble: 5 × 2
#>       i     b
#>   <int> <int>
#> 1     1     1
#> 2     2    NA
#> 3     3     3
#> 4     4    NA
#> 5     5     5
```

Set Union

Combine values from both datasets (full join on rows, all columns):

```
A + B
#> # A tibble: 10 × 3
#>       i     b     c
```

```

#>      <int> <int> <int>
#> 1         1     1     1
#> 2         2     2     2
#> 3         3     3     3
#> 4         4     4     4
#> 5         5     5     5
#> 6         6     6     6
#> 7         7     7     7
#> 8         8     8     8
#> 9         9     9     9
#> 10        10    10    10

```

Union with C - includes all rows (1:10) and all columns (b, c, d):

A + C

```

#> # A tibble: 10 × 4
#>       i     b     c     d
#>   <int> <int> <int> <dbl>
#> 1     1     1     1     2
#> 2     2     2     9     2
#> 3     3     3     3     2
#> 4     4     4     7     2
#> 5     5     5     5     2
#> 6     6     6    NA     6
#> 7     7     7     7     7
#> 8     8     8    NA     8
#> 9     9     9     9     9
#> 10    10    10    NA    10

```

Set Equality

Compare datasets cell-by-cell (requires matching rows and columns):

A == A # All TRUE (or NA for missing values)

```

#> # A tibble: 10 × 3
#>       i b     c
#>   <int> <lgl> <lgl>
#> 1     1 TRUE TRUE
#> 2     2 NA  TRUE
#> 3     3 TRUE TRUE
#> 4     4 NA  TRUE
#> 5     5 TRUE TRUE
#> 6     6 NA  TRUE
#> 7     7 TRUE TRUE
#> 8     8 NA  TRUE
#> 9     9 TRUE TRUE
#> 10    10 NA  TRUE

```

```

A == B # Shows which cells match
#> # A tibble: 10 × 3
#>       i b      c
#>   <int> <lgl> <lgl>
#> 1     1 TRUE  FALSE
#> 2     2 FALSE FALSE
#> 3     3 FALSE FALSE
#> 4     4 FALSE FALSE
#> 5     5 TRUE  FALSE
#> 6     6 FALSE FALSE
#> 7     7 TRUE  FALSE
#> 8     8 FALSE FALSE
#> 9     9 TRUE  FALSE
#> 10    10 FALSE FALSE

```

Equality fails with mismatched rows or columns:

```

A == C # Error: rows and columns don't match
#> Error in dataset_equality(a, b): cols don't align
#> cols left: ibc
#> cols right: ibd

```

Helper Functions

```

# Extract ID columns
ids(A)
#> # A tibble: 10 × 1
#>       i
#>   <int>
#> 1     1
#> 2     2
#> 3     3
#> 4     4
#> 5     5
#> 6     6
#> 7     7
#> 8     8
#> 9     9
#> 10    10

# Extract value columns (non-ID columns)
vals(A)
#> # A tibble: 10 × 2
#>       b      c
#>   <int> <int>
#> 1     1     1
#> 2    NA     2

```

```
#> 3      3      3
#> 4      NA     4
#> 5      5      5
#> 6      NA     6
#> 7      7      7
#> 8      NA     8
#> 9      9      9
#> 10     NA    10
```

Mathematical Properties

The set operations satisfy the fundamental identity: $a = (a \cap b) \cup (a \setminus b)$

```
# Verify: A == (A > B) + (A - B)
all(vals(A == (A > B) + (A - B)), na.rm = TRUE)
#> [1] TRUE
```

License

GPL (≥ 3)